

51Talk IELTS Speaking-Advanced

雅思口语高级

——冲刺 7.5 分



Unit 8 Technology and invention

Topic 6—Lesson 1(上篇)

An item of technology that you couldn't do without



I. Pronunciation Practice (2 minutes)

the Final 'gh'

The final 'gh' makes an /f/ sound:

enough

tough

rough

Read the following words and pay attention to the final 'gh'.



cough /f/

photograph

paragraph

laugh

II. IELTS Speaking Part 1 (8 minutes)



Extend your answer to 3-4 sentences. It's easier to get 7.5.

1. Imagine you are a candidate in the IELTS test. The teacher is an examiner. Please answer the questions below with what you have learned to develop your IELTS answers. (4 minutes)

What is your major?

Do you like it? **Why or why not?**

What do you expect to learn from this major?



The examiner will score your answer from the following aspects:

1. How good you are at **keeping talking** at the right speed and **connecting your ideas together**;
2. **How much vocabulary** you have and **how well** you use it;
3. **How many structures** you have and **how well** you use them;
4. How well you **pronounce** the language.

2. Read and learn the following key words and models for the IELTS Part 1. You are suggested to apply these words in the following steps. (4 minutes)

Key Words and Models

land on



Example: This is a tough question to answer, because I have switched my major more than once. When I first started college I wanted to work in Public Relations; however, after taking a few classes related to this profession I realised you do not need a college degree to be successful in this field. The second major I **landed on** is the one I am set on seeing through until the end. My current major is biology with a focus on neuroscience.

residential course



Example: I positively love studying neuroscience. For me the best part of studying this subject has been the challenges it presents and puzzles that need to be solved. I also adore this subject because it requires me to take several **residential courses** and I love staying in new places to do lab work. Overall, I am completely satisfied with my chosen major.

endocrinologist



Example: The neuroscience major requires diverse courses. You have to take chemistry, biology, physiology etc. I expect to learn about basic cell anatomy and function, chemical proteins, and the various complex structures of the human brain. My overall goal in the future is to become an **endocrinologist** so that I can diagnose and treat hormone-related disorders.

III. IELTS Speaking Part 2 (12 minutes)

1. *Brainstorm. Plan your answers based on the given questions. (1 minute)*

Describe an item of technology that you couldn't do without.

- What is the thing?
- How often do you use it?
- What difference does it make to your life?
- When did you buy this particular piece of technology?
- Why is it so important to you?



Tips: During the first stage of Part 2, you don't need to talk. Keep the questions in mind and think them over.



2.1 Here is a model for the IELTS Speaking Part 2. We will focus on the words and expressions highlighted and in red below. (8 minutes)

Model 1

What the thing is: An **underrated** piece of technology that I could not live without is the microwave oven.

How often you use it: I use my microwave every single day. As I normally cook microwavable dishes, I usually end up using it three times a day.

What difference it makes to your life: Having a microwave in my kitchen has made several key differences to my life. It allows me to save money because **microwavable food** is often inexpensive. The other difference it has made is related to time. Using the microwave creates meals quicker than other methods, giving me more time to do other tasks.

When you bought this particular piece of tech: Whenever I move into a new apartment, I always make sure the microwave is working. If there is any issue whatsoever with it, I will have the landlord replace it. I have never actually had to buy my own microwave as it is an essential part of any living space.

Why it's so important to you: Since I am a terrible cook, this invention enables me to survive by cooking **prepackaged meals**. Even when I do manage to make food, the microwave makes re-heating food much easier than would an oven or stovetop.



You are required to talk for the full 2 minutes.

2.2 Imagine you are a candidate in the IELTS test. The teacher is an examiner. Please answer the questions below with what you have learned to develop your IELTS answers. (3 minutes)

Describe an item of technology that you couldn't do without.

You should say:

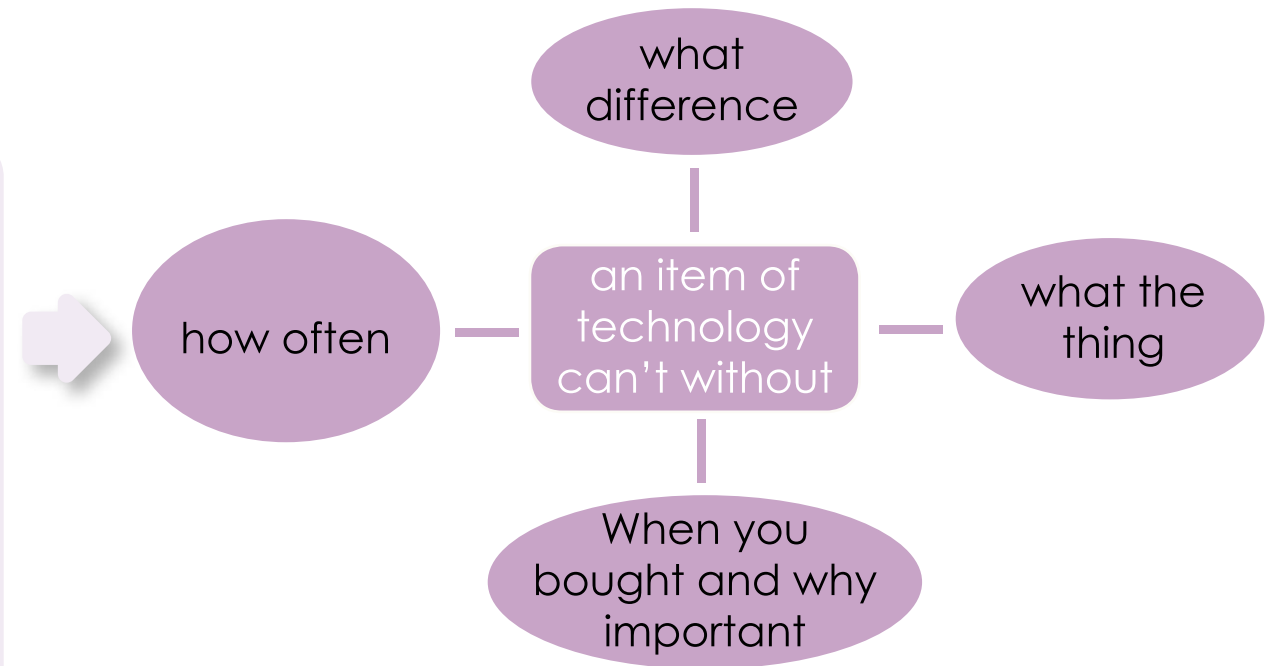
what the thing is

how often you use it

what difference it makes to your life.

when you bought this particular piece of technology

why it is so important to you.



Homework: Please use the model for these two topics for further practice.

Describe a new popular technology.

Describe something popular in your hometown.

Review (2 minutes)



Key Words & Expressions

land on

residential course

endocrinologist

underrated

microwavable food

prepackaged meal



Key Sentences

The second major I **landed on** is the one I am set on seeing through until the end. My current major is biology with a focus on neuroscience.

I also adore this subject because it requires me to take several **residential courses** and I love staying in new places to do lab work.

My overall goal in the future is to become an **endocrinologist** so that I can diagnose and treat hormone-related disorders.

An **underrated** piece of technology that I could not live without is the microwave oven.

It allows me to save money because **microwavable food** is often inexpensive.

Since I am a terrible cook, this invention enables me to survive by cooking **prepackaged meals**.

You will learn more about this topic in Lesson 2.